Consumables

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Overview

One of the main reasons to utilize a CMMS is to track and manage the costs of materials needed for an organization. A CMMS can help with budgeting for the future and generate reports on past usage. One aspect of AIMS 3 to help with this is through the utilization of Consumables. Consumables refers to anything that is categorized as inventory inside of an organization that is not a Part for a piece of Equipment or a Work Order. This could mean scrubs for the technicians, bandages for a First Aid Kit, or even sheets for a bed. Every Consumable, no matter how minor, should be accounted for to ensure accurate records.

In addition, the necessary data managers must be configured for the Consumables component to display data in its dropdown menus. Refer to the Data Managers How-To Guide for information on the required data managers and configuration steps.

Consumables Tool Bar



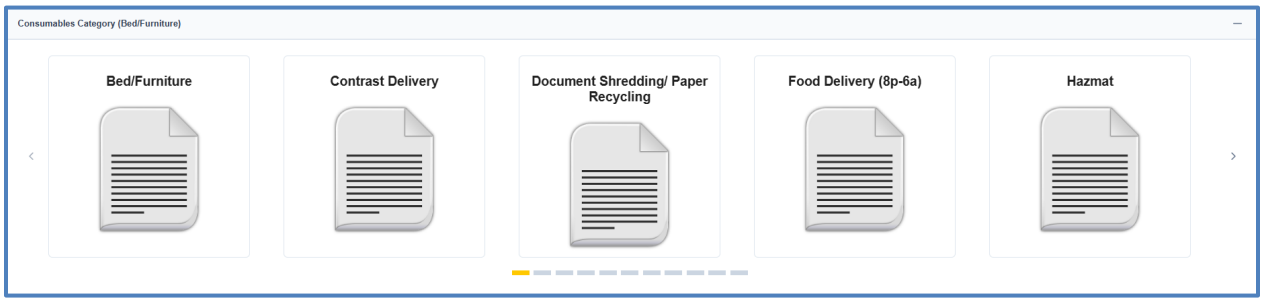
The Consumables Tool Bar allows users to accomplish common tasks. These icons are used everywhere through the system. AIMS 3 allows users to see what each button does by simply hovering the cursor over the icon. The Menu Bar will be consistent from user to user.

Consumables and End Users

While the Consumables component is for users in the AIMS 3 program, including technicians, admins, and super users; End Users may also find it as a useful tool to create Purchase Request/Purchase Orders through the Consumables Category inside of the EasyNet Pages.

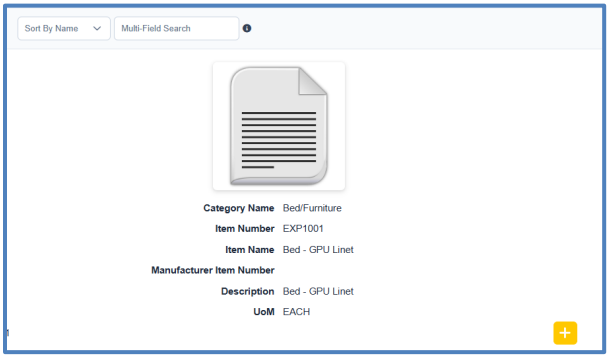
When creating an EasyNet Page with the capability of Consumables, users will need to ensure the check box 

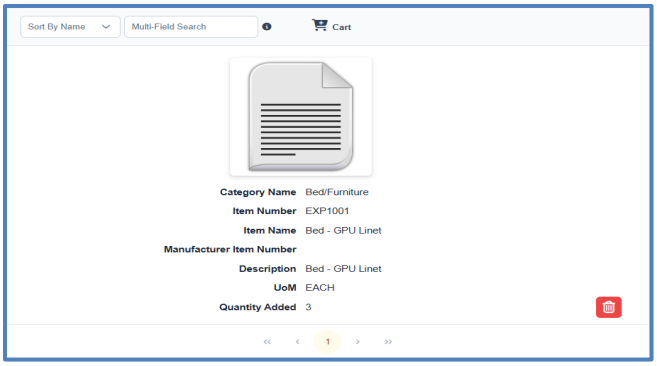
is selected. Once selected, the Consumable Categories will appear in the EasyNet Page (along with photos) for the End Users to choose from.



Once a Category is selected (i.e. Bed/Furniture, Hazmat, etc.), users will then need to select the specific item(s) they are looking for.

To add the consumable to the shopping cart, users will select the specific consumable and select the  button. Selecting the button multiple times will increase the quantity in the shopping cart. After completing the Shopping Cart, end users will select the Submit button at the top left of the page.





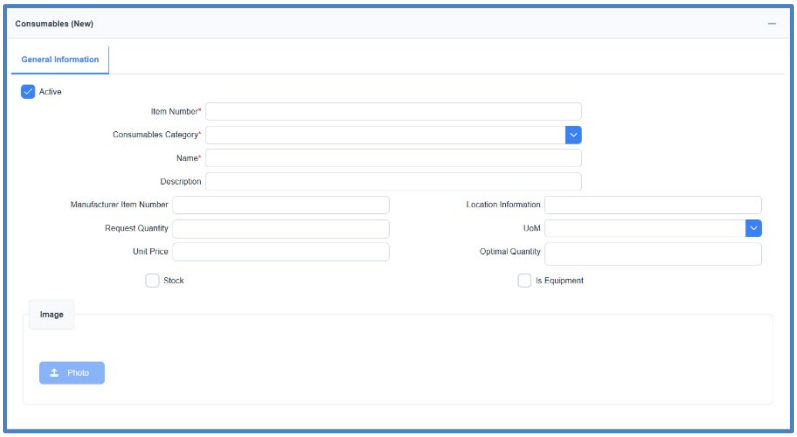
After the end user has created the Request, a request will then be placed either through the Dispatch Queue or the Purchasing Component to be ordered via a user inside of AIMS 3.

Creating a New Consumable

Adding a Consumable is a simple tool that anyone with AIMS 3 access can create in a few simple steps.

To begin the process, users will need to click the "+" icon in the top left corner of the tool bar. Doing so will open a new page where information can be entered.

Users will then need to fill out the following information:
(Fields with a red asterisk are required by the system.)



- **Item Number**: The main identifying number of the Consumable to search by
- **Consumables Category**: The category to which the consumable belongs
- **Name:** The common name of the Consumable
- **Description**: A further description of the consumable (could include measurements)
- **Manufacturer Item Number**: The OEM number of the Consumable
- **Location**: A free text location field to tell where the consumable is in the facility
- **Request Quantity**: The quantity at which consumables should be ordered
- **UOM**: Unit of Measurement
- **Unit Price**: The cost of each unit for the facility when reordering
- **Optimal Quantity**: How many of each consumable to be maintained in the facility

Conclusion

The Consumable component of AIMS 3 enables Administrators to accurately record information about the Consumables at their organization. This includes robust tools to receive, transfer, and adjust information to help with future budgeting. It is essential to establish strong workflows to ensure all necessary information is recorded to maintain compliance and patient safety.

If Administrators require additional consulting or training, Phoenix Data Systems is available to assist at any level. Please contact our Sales Department or Project Managers for more information.

Appendix

To support your learning, we have created a How-To Guide in video format that walks you through each step visually. Simply click the link to be taken directly to our YouTube page, where you can watch the full set of tutorials at your own pace. This is a great way to follow along, revisit key actions, and get comfortable with the workflow.

Consumables Component